Country Hills Public School

School Council Meeting Minutes

Feb/27/2024 6:30 pm

Chair: Josh Windle

Member Attendance:

Present:

- Beth Creighton, Jennifer Boyer, Aaron Fewkes
- Robert Real, Karthik Shivkumar, Bethany Leis, Keiko App, Josh Windle, Kawaljeet Kaur, Ming Hui Huang, Laura Eady

Absent:

- Ana Quintanilla, Courtney Lovell, Tarra Stumpf

Regrets:

- Joanna Kneale

1. **Call to Order** – Josh Windle
2. **Territorial Acknowledgement** – Spoken by President Josh Windle
3. **Approval of Minutes of previous meeting** – Approved
4. **Approval/Additions to the Agenda** - Checked by Chair Mr. Windle and confirmed approved by all the council members
5. **Principal's Report** – Beth Creighton
    - Picture day tomorrow, also Pink shirt day to show commitment to creating a safe and inclusive school environment

        - Plan to post document on school day with a chart to give description of 3 ways on how students can recognize bullying
        - Power control when bully has the power
        - Family and parents and students understanding
    - Great to have a presentation in school council on bullying and recognize
        - What to expect when a complain happens - Automatic suspension is not followed by bullying
        - Anti-bullying initiative
        - Some students have difficulties with behavior and sometimes classified as bully, need to understand those
        - Open dialogue so children feel comfortable coming home and share what happened
        - There could be bullying on social media and there are hidden signs as well
        - Some have trouble recognizing, idea is to help recognize
    - Committee anti-bullying – 9 students opted for survey, led by Mr Fewkes
        - End of May, some standardized survey information
    - Newsletter this Friday by nurse Mallory with Survey
        - Where they are involved and where they would like to be involved
        - What would help
        - Would it be better to have childcare if provided during council meetings
    - Parking on side streets – do not believe they are parents, just neighbors complaining
        - It can be unsafe
        - Trying to encourage families not walking through parking lot
        - At April meeting, could be included in minutes
    - School improvement plan
        - Math and language, increasing belonging
        - Not necessarily academic focus
    - Staff changes – Ms Christine – had baby
    - Megan Bentley till end of June
    - New EA member - Deepak Sapkota

6. **Educator Representative Reports** - Aaron Fewkes and Joanna Kneale

Update - Mr. Fewkes:

- Red, white and pink day enjoyed by primary students!
- Winter walk to school day occurred on Feb 7th; lots of families participated, lower number of students on the bus/cars.

- *NEW* Carnaval at Country Hills being organized by Mme. Swabey and Mme. Harms. It will happen on March 1st, middle block, and include a variety of outdoor winter activities. Similar to Free-Flow Fridays historically done at beginning and end of year.
- Upcoming Spirit Day: March 8 (the day before March Break) = "Bring on the Sun Day"
- Coding Club has begun for Junior students; thanks to the leadership of teacher candidate Mr. Finnigan.
- Friendship week was from Feb 12 - 16. Organized by Kirk's Crew, under the leadership of Ms. St John and Mrs. McLeman, students participated in bulletin board decoration (ideas for kindness), school friendship bracelet making, candy guessing, and more.
- Another spirit assembly happened on Feb 16; thanks to Mrs. Kneale and Mrs. McIntosh.
- Kodaly Choir is continuing to practice, and we also had some solo auditions this week. Our Kodaly Choir performance is on May 8 at Center in the Square.

7. Treasurer's Report –

- Reported balance - Dec 31 – $4771.31

8. Sub-Committee Reports

- WRAPSC Reports

No report

- Fundraising Update – by Mr. Fewkes
  - Plan for next year because we are late in year
  - Outdoor activities in outdoor, make recess better – opportunities to use energy in better way
  - In fall, like sensory pathway project.
  - Getting partnership letter ready, letter translated, - clear msg
  - All members asked to suggest small business whose goals aligns with children welfare, development, and they need to be pitched, we would be happy to pitch for them to match so they can help and contribute to our fundraising goals.
  - Encourage volunteers to help with school yard cleanup in spring
    - Question asked by Ms. Tarra Stumpf - Are we not stepping on custodians' responsibilities?
    - Answer provided by principal Mrs Creighton – Custodian is responsible for day to day safety. Gardening is not his job duties

9. Discussion Items

- Wood chips spreading in school yard
    - Was regulated in past, can't just get from anywhere
    - Can't go from free pickup
    - Will Check again if anybody can go and get it
    - Nice to have item (if Ground uneven , that will be classified safety concern)

- Gym floor to be done
- Library renovation
    - Have to store library offsite
    - Will be beautiful, tv for presentations
    - No carpet
    - Couchy comfortable area for students
    - Renovation done from ill be from June to October 2024
    - library will be closed, by last week of May, so events cannot be planned during that time (far end of May)

- Potluck. for staff - to appreciate staff

- Discussion on multicultural arts day
    - Henna
    - Reconciliation area
    - Book swap, clothing swap
    - Fence setup, station, parents and families could paint

- volunteer committee
    - can be students, or others, not just parents
    - Many come to watch flag raising, we can invite them to volunteer

- school bylaw committee
    - Mr. Windle suggested to use another schools bylaw as the initial template and change verbiage

    - Will try to have it in 3 weeks for everybody

- Meeting time
    - Ask about 6 o'clock instead of 6:30 pm
    - Most said 6 o'clock is fine, fair for teacher
    - Might be from next year

- Spirit wear
    - Some kids also found interested
    - just for staff in spring
    - In fall for kids

10.Future Meeting Dates

- Apr 30th 2023
- May 28th 2023